

❖ Fractions Made Fun ❖

Dividing Fractions

Keep • Change • Flip • Multiply • Simplify

1. What Is a Fraction?

A fraction represents a **part of a whole**. When something is divided into equal parts, each part is a fraction.

Term	Meaning	Example
Numerator	Top number – how many parts we have	3 in $\frac{3}{4}$
Denominator	Bottom number – total equal parts	4 in $\frac{3}{4}$
Proper fraction	Numerator < Denominator	$\frac{2}{5}$
Improper fraction	Numerator > Denominator	$\frac{7}{4}$
Mixed number	Whole number + fraction	1 and $\frac{3}{4}$

2. What Does Dividing Fractions Mean?

Dividing fractions means finding out **how many times one fraction fits into another**.

Think of it like asking: "*How many halves fit into three quarters?*"

■ Real-life Example

You have $\frac{3}{4}$ of a pizza. Each person gets $\frac{1}{2}$ a pizza's worth. How many people can you feed?

Answer: 1 and $\frac{1}{2}$ people!

3. The Five Steps: Keep – Change – Flip – Multiply – Simplify

1 KEEP

Keep the first fraction exactly as it is.

$\frac{3}{4} \div \frac{1}{2} \rightarrow$ **Keep $\frac{3}{4}$**

2 CHANGE

Change the division sign ($\div$) to a multiplication sign ($\times$).

$\frac{3}{4} \div \frac{1}{2} \rightarrow$ **$\frac{3}{4} \times \dots$**

3	FLIP	Flip the second fraction (swap numerator and denominator). This is called finding the reciprocal.	$1/2$ flipped $\rightarrow 2/1$
4	MULTIPLY	Multiply straight across: top $\times$ top, bottom $\times$ bottom.	$3/4 \times 2/1 = 6/4$ ($3 \times 2 = 6$, $4 \times 1 = 4$)
5	SIMPLIFY	Reduce to lowest terms by dividing by the greatest common factor (GCF).	$6/4 = 3/2 = 1$ and $1/2$

4. Worked Example: $2/3 \div 4/5$

Step	Action	Working	Result
1 – Keep	Keep the first fraction	—	$2/3$
2 – Change	Change $\div$ to $\times$	$2/3 \times$	...
3 – Flip	Flip $4/5$ to get its reciprocal	$4/5 \rightarrow 5/4$	$5/4$
4 – Multiply	$2/3 \times 5/4 = (2 \times 5) / (3 \times 4)$	$10 / 12$	$10/12$
5 – Simplify	Divide top & bottom by GCF (2)	$10 \div 2 / 12 \div 2$	$5/6$ ✓

✓ Final Answer: $2/3 \div 4/5 = 5/6$

5. Word Problems

Read each problem carefully, then use the **Keep–Change–Flip** method to solve it.

■ Q1. Chocolate Bars	Priya has $3/4$ of a chocolate bar. She wants to share it equally among 3 friends. How much does each friend get? Answer: _____
■ Q2. Recipe Ingredients	Arjun needs $2/3$ cup of flour. His measuring cup holds $1/6$ cup. How many scoops does he need? Answer: _____
■ Q3. Ribbon Pieces	Meera has $4/5$ metre of ribbon. She cuts it into pieces that are $1/10$ metre each. How many pieces can she make? Answer: _____

6. Practice Problems

Solve these on your own using the steps you've learned!

Q1. $\frac{2}{3} \div \frac{1}{4} =$ _____	Q2. $\frac{5}{6} \div \frac{2}{3} =$ _____
Q3. $\frac{3}{5} \div \frac{1}{2} =$ _____	Q4. $\frac{4}{7} \div \frac{2}{5} =$ _____
Q5. $\frac{1}{2} \div \frac{3}{4} =$ _____	Q6. $\frac{7}{8} \div \frac{1}{4} =$ _____

7. Common Mistakes to Avoid

X Forgetting to flip the second fraction	✓ Always flip the SECOND fraction, not the first!
X Multiplying the wrong fractions	✓ After flipping, multiply top×top and bottom×bottom.
X Not simplifying the final answer	✓ Always check if you can reduce your fraction further.
X Flipping the first fraction instead of the second	✓ Only the divisor (second fraction) gets flipped.

8. Key Takeaways

KEEP	CHANGE	FLIP	MULTIPLY	SIMPLIFY
Keep the first fraction as-is	Change $\div$ to $\times$	Flip the second fraction	Multiply top×top bottom×bottom	Simplify to lowest terms

Answer Key

Problem	Working	Answer
$\frac{2}{3} \div \frac{1}{4}$	$\frac{2}{3} \times \frac{4}{1} = \frac{8}{3}$	2 and $\frac{2}{3}$
$\frac{5}{6} \div \frac{2}{3}$	$\frac{5}{6} \times \frac{3}{2} = \frac{15}{12}$	1 and $\frac{1}{4}$
$\frac{3}{5} \div \frac{1}{2}$	$\frac{3}{5} \times \frac{2}{1} = \frac{6}{5}$	1 and $\frac{1}{5}$
$\frac{4}{7} \div \frac{2}{5}$	$\frac{4}{7} \times \frac{5}{2} = \frac{20}{14}$	1 and $\frac{3}{7}$
$\frac{1}{2} \div \frac{3}{4}$	$\frac{1}{2} \times \frac{4}{3} = \frac{4}{6}$	$\frac{2}{3}$

Problem	Working	Answer
$7/8 \div 1/4$	$7/8 \times 4/1 = 28/8$	3 and $1/2$
Word Q1	$3/4 \div 3 = 3/4 \times 1/3 = 3/12$	$1/4$
Word Q2	$2/3 \div 1/6 = 2/3 \times 6/1 = 12/3$	4 scoops
Word Q3	$4/5 \div 1/10 = 4/5 \times 10/1 = 40/5$	8 pieces

◆ You've got this! Keep practising and fractions will feel like second nature. ◆